THE SHE LIST UNDER 50

THE **SPORTSWOMEN**

Packing a Punch

WHAT MAKES HER A SHERO

Coming from a family of boxers, Jaismine Lamboria won gold at the 2026 Commonwealth Games in the 57 kg category, besides winning the world championship in 2025

Photograph by **CHANDRADEEP KUMAR**

An athlete is sustained as much by mental victories as physical ones. Boxer Jaismine Lamboria, who won gold at this year's Commonwealth Games, has learnt this again and again, like with her quarterfinal loss at the 2023 Asian Games. "It was my biggest turning point," she recalls. "I had never learnt as much with anything I had achieved before. I was very low, but then you get up, assess what went wrong and move on." Jaismine credits her psychologist at the Army Sports Institute, Pune, with instilling confidence in her decisions, whether they lead to victory or defeat. "I learnt through my sessions that, as athletes, we have short careers, so the only way to go about them is to do it unabashedly."

JAISMINE LAMBORIA, 24
Boxer
Bhiwani, Haryana

A decision that proved fruitful was during the 2024 Olympics qualifications, when she dropped from the 60 kg to the 57 kg category. Two years later, she has won gold in both the 2025 World Boxing Championship and 2025 World Boxing Cup, and has converted the 2022 CWG bronze to gold.

This was partly achieved by no longer clinging to a defensive stance. She now returns the favour when she's hit with a volley of punches, ensuring opponents stay on their toes. ■

—Udbhav Seth

HER INSPIRATION

"I learn a bit from sportspersons of every discipline: Mary Kom, Neeraj Chopra, Milkha Singh, M.S. Dhoni.... I admire one's discipline, one's nature, someone's willpower and another's determination"